The Storm

The Storm

A Collection of the Most Remarkable Casualties and Disasters which happened in the Late Dreadful Tempest, both by Sea and Land

Daniel Defoe

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The Storm; or, a Collection of the Most Remarkable Casualties and Disasters which happened in the Late Dreadful Tempest, both by Sea and Land
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A Note On This Edition

This edition of *The Storm* is based on the 1704 first edition, originally printed in London by George Sawbridge and sold by J. Nutt. The text is reproduced complete and unabridged, with archaic spellings modernized and original italics and capitalization rationalized where necessary for ease of reading. These changes have been kept to a minimum and do not otherwise alter Defoe's language. Punctuation follows the primary source faithfully, with corrections limited to clear typographical errors and cases of textual uncertainty, such as where the absence of an apostrophe makes it unclear whether a word is plural or possessive.

The storm which forms the subject of this book struck Great Britain on the night of November 26, 1703. For several days, violent winds swept across the country, destroying houses, uprooting trees, wrecking ships, and taking thousands of lives. The devastation was so extensive that it quickly became a national event—not merely a catastrophe witnessed by those who endured it, but an event whose effects were felt throughout the kingdom.

Daniel Defoe was determined that the experience should not be forgotten. In the days following the storm, Defoe issued a public appeal for firsthand accounts. The advertisement preceding this preface is transcribed from the original notice published in *The London Gazette* on December 2, 1703. In it, Defoe called upon those who had witnessed the storm to communicate what they had seen, heard, and suffered. Their accounts would become the raw material for the work that followed.

The inclusion of this advertisement is therefore more than a bibliographical curiosity. It preserves the beginning of Defoe's investigation and reveals something essential about the nature of *The Storm*. Defoe was not content merely to relate what he had personally experienced or to repeat the reports already circulating in London.

He sought testimony. He gathered accounts from across England, compared the experiences of different communities, and attempted to preserve the memory of the disaster through the voices of those who had actually lived through it.

The circumstances surrounding Defoe's engagement with the storm were themselves remarkable. In "The Storm, An Essay," included in this volume, he writes from what he cryptically calls the 'limbus of the law,' declaring that he had never told his readers where he was. The poem thus offers a brief glimpse into the precarious circumstances in which its author found himself. Yet, amid his personal uncertainty, Defoe turned outward, gathering and preserving the experiences of others. One of Defoe's most remarkable journalistic projects thus emerged during one of the most difficult periods of his life.

The result is a work remarkable for both its immediacy and its method. *The Storm* occupies an unusual place between journalism and history. It records ships lost at sea and houses destroyed on land, but it also records the bewilderment, fear, courage, and grief of ordinary people confronted with a force beyond their control. Defoe's great achievement was to recognize that these individual experiences, easily scattered and forgotten, together formed a national history worth preserving.

For Defoe, however, the storm was not merely a natural event. The disaster prompted widespread reflection upon providence, mortality, human frailty, and the moral condition of the nation. The destruction of property and the loss of life raised questions that could not be answered by statistics alone. What did such an event mean? How should it be remembered? And what ought those who survived to learn from it?

Two companion works included in this volume help to answer those questions. "The Storm, An Essay" and "The Layman's Sermon Upon the Late Storm" broaden the record beyond the immediate narrative of destruction. Together, they reveal the storm as it was interpreted by contemporaries: as a natural catastrophe, a national crisis, a political event, and, above all, a subject of serious moral and spiritual reflection. Defoe's own poem is particularly revealing, combining his interpretation of the storm as an act of providence with reflections upon the political condition of the nation and the personal circumstances of its author.

More than three centuries later, the immediacy of Defoe's subject has not entirely disappeared. Storms still destroy homes, ships are still lost at sea, and communities still struggle to make sense of sudden catastrophe. What has changed is the speed with which such events are recorded and forgotten. Defoe worked without modern communications, yet he understood something that remains remarkably relevant: when disaster strikes, the testimony of ordinary people is precious. Once the witnesses are gone, what was seen and suffered can easily vanish with them.

This edition seeks to preserve that testimony in the form in which Defoe first presented it. Along with the complete text, we have restored the advertisement that initiated his investigation and included the companion works that help place *The Storm* within its original cultural and spiritual context.

We trust that these pages will serve not merely as a record of a night long remembered, but as a reminder of the value of preserving history while its witnesses can still speak.

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The Preface

Preaching of sermons is speaking to a few of mankind: printing of books is talking to the whole world. The parson prescribes himself, and addresses to the particular auditory with the appellation of 'My brethren'; but he that prints a book, ought to preface it with a *Noverint universi*—know all men by these presents.

The proper inference drawn from this remarkable observation, is, that though he that preaches from the pulpit ought to be careful of his words, that nothing pass from him but with an especial sanction of truth; yet he that prints and publishes to all the world, has a tenfold obligation.

The sermon is a sound of words spoken to the ear, and prepared only for present meditation, and extends no farther than the strength of memory can convey it; a book printed is a record, remaining in every man's possession, always ready to renew its acquaintance with his memory, and always ready to be produced as an authority or voucher to any reports he makes out of it, and conveys its contents for ages to come, to the eternity of mortal time, when the author is forgotten in his grave.

If a sermon be ill grounded, if the preacher imposes upon us, he trespasses on a few; but if a book printed obtrudes a falsehood, if a man tells a lie in print, he abuses mankind, and imposes upon the whole world, he causes our children to tell lies after us, and their children after them, to the end of the world.

This observation I thought good to make by way of preface, to let the world know, that when I go about a work in which I must tell a great many stories, which may in their own nature seem incredible, and in which I must expect a great part of mankind will question the sincerity of the relator; I did not do it without a particular sense upon me of the proper duty of an historian, and the abundant duty laid on him to be very wary what he conveys to posterity.

I cannot be so ignorant of my own intentions, as not to know, that in many cases I shall act the divine, and draw necessary practical inferences from the extraordinary remarkables of this book, and some digressions which I hope may not be altogether useless in this case.

And while I pretend to a thing so solemn, I cannot but premise I should stand convicted of a double imposture, to forge a story, and then preach repentance to the reader from a crime greater than that I would have him repent of: endeavouring by a lie to correct the reader's vices, and sin against truth to bring the reader off from sinning against sense.

Upon this score, though the undertaking be very difficult among such an infinite variety of circumstances, to keep exactly within the bounds of truth; yet I have this positive assurance with me, that in all the subsequent relation, if the least mistake happen, it shall not be mine.

If I judge right, 'tis the duty of an historian to set everything in its own light, and to convey matter of fact upon its legitimate authority, and no other: I mean thus (for I would be as explicit as I can), that where a story is vouched to him with sufficient authority, he ought to give the world the special testimonial of its proper voucher, or else he is not just to the story: and where it comes without such sufficient authority, he ought to say so; otherwise he is not just to himself. In the first case he injures the history, by leaving it doubtful where it might be confirmed past all manner of question; in the last he injures his own reputation, by taking upon himself the risk, in case it proves a mistake, of having the world charge him with a forgery.

And indeed, I cannot but own it is just, that if I tell a story in print for a truth which proves otherwise, unless I, at the same time, give proper caution to the reader, by owning the uncertainty of my knowledge in the matter of fact, 'tis I impose upon the world; my relator is innocent, and the lie is my own.

I make all these preliminary observations, partly to inform the reader, that I have not undertaken this work without the serious consideration of what I owe to truth, and to posterity; nor without a sense of the extraordinary variety and novelty of the relation.

I am sensible, that the want of this caution is the foundation of that great misfortune we have in matters of ancient history; in which

the impudence, the ribaldry, the empty flourishes, the little regard to truth, and the fondness of telling a strange story, has dwindled a great many valuable pieces of ancient history into mere romance.

How are the lives of some of our most famous men, nay, the actions of whole ages, drowned in fable? Not that there wanted penmen to write, but that their writings were continually mixed with such rhodomontades[1] of the authors that posterity rejected them as fabulous.

From hence it comes to pass that matters of fact are handed down to posterity with so little certainty, that nothing is to be depended upon; from hence the uncertain account of things and actions in the remoter ages of the world, the confounding the genealogies as well as achievements of Belus, Nimrod, and Nimrus, and their successors, the histories and originals of Saturn, Jupiter, and the rest of the celestial rabble, who mankind would have been ashamed to have called *gods*, had they had the true account of their dissolute, exorbitant, and inhuman lives.

From men we may descend to action: and this prodigious looseness of the pen has confounded history and fable from the beginning of both. Thus the great flood in Deucalion's time is made to pass for the Universal Deluge: the ingenuity of Daedalus, who by a clue of thread got out of the Egyptian maze, which was thought impossible, is grown into a fable of making himself a pair of wings, and flying through the air:—the great drought and violent heat of summer, thought to be the time when the Great Famine was in Samaria, fabled by the poets and historians into Phaeton borrowing the chariot of the sun, and giving the horses their heads, they run so near the earth as burnt up all the nearest parts, and scorched the inhabitants, so that they have been black in those parts ever since.

These, and such like ridiculous stuff, have been the effects of the pageantry of historians in former ages: and I might descend nearer home, to the legends of fabulous history which have swallowed up the actions of our ancient predecessors, King Arthur, the giant Gogmagog, and the Briton, the stories of St. George and the Dragon, Guy Earl of Warwick, Bevis of Southampton, and the like.

I'll account for better conduct in the ensuing history: and though some things here related shall have equal wonder due to

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[1]Rhodomontade: boastful, arrogant, or vainglorious speech or behavior

them, posterity shall not have equal occasion to distrust the verity of the relation.

I confess here is room for abundance of romance, because the subject may be safer extended than in any other case, no story being capable to be crowded with such circumstances, but Infinite Power, which is all along concerned with us in every relation, is supposed capable of making true.

Yet we shall nowhere so trespass upon fact, as to oblige Infinite Power to the showing more miracles than it intended.

It must be allowed, that when nature was put into so much confusion, and the surface of the earth and sea felt such extraordinary a disorder, innumerable accidents would fall out that, till the like occasion happen, may never more be seen, and unless a like occasion had happened, could never before be heard of: wherefore the particular circumstances being so wonderful, serve but to remember posterity of the more wonderful extreme, which was the immediate cause.

The uses and application made from this terrible doctrine, I leave to the men of the pulpit; only take the freedom to observe, that when Heaven itself lays down the doctrine, all men are summoned to make applications by themselves.

The main inference I shall pretend to make or at least venture the exposing to public view, in this case, is, the strong evidence God has been pleased to give in this terrible manner to his own being, which mankind began more than ever to affront and despise: and I cannot but have so much charity for the worst of my fellow-creatures, that I believe no man was so hardened against the sense of his Maker, but he felt some shocks of his wicked confidence from the convulsions of nature at this time.

I cannot believe any man so rooted in atheistical opinions, as not to find some cause to doubt whether he was not in the wrong, and a little to apprehend the possibility of a Supreme Being, when he felt the terrible blasts of this tempest. I cannot doubt but the atheist's hardened soul trembled a little as well as his house, and he felt some nature asking him some little questions; as these — *Am not I mistaken? Certainly there is some such thing as a God — What can all this be? What is the matter in the world?*

Certainly atheism is one of the most irrational principles in the world; there is something incongruous in it with the test of human

policy, because there is a risk in the mistake one way, and none another. If the Christian is mistaken, and it should at last appear that there is no future state, God or Devil, reward or punishment, where is the harm of it? All he has lost is, that he has practiced a few needless mortifications, and took the pains to live a little more like a man than he would have done. But if the atheist is mistaken, he has brought all the Powers, whose being he denied, upon his back, has provoked the Infinite in the highest manner, and must at last sink under the anger of him whose nature he has always disowned.

I would recommend this thought to any man to consider of, one way he can lose nothing, the other way be undone. Certainly a wise man would never run such an unequal risk: a man cannot answer it to common arguments, the law of numbers, and the rules of proportion are against him. No gamester will set at such a main; no man will lay such a wager, where he may lose, but cannot win.

There is another unhappy misfortune in the mistake too, that it can never be discovered till 'tis too late to remedy. He that resolves to die an atheist, shuts the door against being convinced in time.

If it should so fall out, as who can tell,
But that there is a God, a Heaven, and Hell,
Mankind had best consider well for fear,
'T should be too late when his mistakes appear.

I should not pretend to set up for an instructor in this case, were not the inference so exceeding just; who can but preach where there is such a text? When God himself speaks his own power, he expects we should draw just inferences from it, both for ourselves and our friends.

If one man, in an hundred years, shall arrive at a conviction of the being of his Maker, 'tis very worth my while to write it, and to bear the character of an impertinent fellow from all the rest.

I thought to make some apology for the meanness of style, and the method, which may be a little unusual, of printing letters from the country in their own style.

For the last I only leave this short reason with the reader, the desire I had to keep close to the truth, and hand my relation with the true authorities from whence I received it, together with some justice to the gentlemen concerned, who, especially in cases of deliverances,

are willing to record the testimonial of the mercies they received, and to set their hands to the humble acknowledgment. The plainness and honesty of the story will plead for the meanness of the style in many of the letters, and the reader cannot want eyes to see what sort of people some of them come from.

Others speak for themselves, and being writ by men of letters, as well as men of principles, I have not arrogance enough to attempt a correction either of the sense or style; and if I had gone about it, should have injured both author and reader.

These come dressed in their own words because I ought not, and those because I could not mend them. I am persuaded, they are all dressed in the desirable, though unfashionable, garb of truth, and I doubt not but posterity will read them with pleasure.

The gentlemen, who have taken the pains to collect and transmit the particular relations here made public, I hope will have their end answered in this essay, conveying hereby to the ages to come the memory of the dreadfulest and most universal judgment that ever Almighty Power thought fit to bring upon this part of the world.

And as this was the true native and original design of the first undertaking, abstracted from any part of the printer's advantage, the editor and undertakers of this work, having their ends entirely answered, hereby give their humble thanks to all those gentlemen who have so far approved the sincerity of their design as to contribute their trouble, and help forward by their just observations, the otherwise very difficult undertaking.

If posterity will but make the desired improvement both of the collector's pains, as well as the several gentlemen's care in furnishing the particulars, I dare say they will all acknowledge their end fully answered, and none more readily than

The Age's Humble Servant.

Advertisement

London Gazette — December 2, 1703

To preserve the remembrance of the late dreadful tempest, an exact and faithful collection is preparing of the most remarkable disasters which happened on that occasion, with the places where, and persons concerned, whether at sea or on shore. For the perfecting so good a work, 'tis humbly recommended by the author to all gentlemen of the clergy, or others, who have made any observations of this calamity, that they would transmit as distinct an account as possible, of what they have observed, to the undertakers, directed to John Nutt near Stationers' Hall, London. All gentlemen that are pleased to send any such accounts, are desired to write no particulars but what they are well satisfied to be true, and to set their names to the observations they send, which the undertakers of this work promise shall be faithfully recorded, and the favour publicly acknowledged.

Chapter One

Of the natural causes and original of winds

Though a system of exhalation, dilation, and extension, things which the ancients founded the doctrine of winds upon, be not my direct business; yet it cannot but be needful to the present design to note, that the difference in the opinions of the ancients, about the nature and original of winds, is a leading step to one assertion which I have advanced in all that I have said with relation to winds, *viz.* That there seems to be more of God in the whole appearance, than in any other part of operating nature.

Nor do I think I need explain myself very far in this notion: I allow the high Original of nature to be the Great Author of all her actings, and by the strict rein of his Providence, is the continual and exact guide of her executive power; but still 'tis plain that in some of the principal parts of nature she is naked to our eye. Things appear both in their causes and consequences, demonstration gives its assistance, and finishes our further inquiries: for we never inquire after God in those works of nature which depending upon the course of things are plain and demonstrative; but where we find nature defective in her discovery, where we see effects but cannot reach their causes; there it is most just, and nature herself seems to direct us to it, to end the rational inquiry, and reserve it into speculation: nature plainly refers us beyond herself, to the mighty hand of Infinite Power, the Author of Nature, and Original of all causes.

Among these arcana[2] of the sovereign economy, the winds are laid as far back as any. Those ancient men of genius who rifled nature by the torchlight of reason even to her very nudities, have been run

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[2]Arcana: (Latin arcanum) Deep secrets or hidden mysteries; the internal, inscrutable workings of a system—in this case, the Divine government of the natural world.

aground in this unknown channel; the wind has blown out the candle of reason, and left them all in the dark.

Aristotle, in his problems, Sect. 23, calls the wind, "*Aeris Impulsum.*"[3] Seneca says, "*Ventus est aer fluens.*"[4] The Stoics held it, "*Motum aut fluxionem aeris.*"[5] Mr. Hobbes,[6] "Air moved in a direct or undulating motion." Fournier, "*Le vent est un mouvement agitation de l'air causé par des exhalations et vapeurs.*"[7] The moderns, "A hot and dry exhalation repulsed by antiperistasis;"[8] Descartes defines it, "*Venti nihil sunt nisi motus, etc.*"[9] *Dilati vapores*, and various other opinions are very judiciously collected by the learned Mr. Bohun in his treatise of the *Origin and Properties of Wind*, and concludes, "That no one hypothesis, how comprehensive soever, has yet been able to resolve all the incident phenomena of winds."[10]

This is what I quote them for, and this is all my argument demands; the deepest search into the region of cause and consequence, has found out just enough to leave the wisest philosopher in the dark, to bewilder his head, and drown his understanding. You raise a storm in nature by the very inquiry; and at last, to be rid of you, she confesses the truth and tells you, "It is not in me, you must go home and ask my father."

Whether then it be the motion of air, and what that air is, *which as yet is undefined*, whether it is a dilation, a previous contraction, and then violent extension as in gunpowder, whether the motion is direct, circular, or oblique, whether it be an exhalation repulsed

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[3]Trans. A striking of the air.

[4]Trans. Wind is moving air.

[5]Trans. The motion or flux of air.

[6]Thomas Hobbes.

[7]Trans. Wind is a movement or agitation of the air caused by exhalations and vapors.

[8]Antiperistasis: An obsolete physical theory suggesting that a quality (such as heat or cold) intensifies when surrounded by its opposite; here used to explain the compressed motion of air as a cause of wind.

[9]Trans. Winds are nothing but motion, etc.

[10]Bohun, Of Winds, p. 7, 9

by the Middle Region,[11] and the antiperistasis of that part of the heavens which is set as a wall of brass to bind up the atmosphere, and keep it within its proper compass for the functions of respiration condensing and rarefying, without which nature would be all in confusion; whatever are their efficient causes,[12] 'tis not much to the immediate design.

'Tis apparent, that God Almighty, whom the philosophers care as little as possible to have anything to do with, seems to have reserved this, as one of those secrets in nature which should more directly guide them to himself.

Not but that a philosopher may be a Christian, and some of the best of the latter have been the best of the former, as Vossius, Mr. Boyle, Sir Walter Raleigh, Lord Verulam,[13] Dr. Harvey, and others; and I wish I could say Mr. Hobbes, for 'twas pity there should lie any just exceptions to the piety of a man, who had so few to his general knowledge, and an exalted spirit in philosophy.

When therefore I say the philosophers do not care to concern God himself in the search after natural knowledge; I mean, as it concerns natural knowledge, *merely as such*; for 'tis a natural cause they seek, from a general maxim, that all nature has its cause within itself: 'tis true, 'tis the darkest part of the search, to trace the chain backward; to begin at the consequence, and from thence *hunt counter*, as we may call it, to find out the cause: 'twould be much easier if we could begin at the cause, and trace it to all its consequences.

I make no question, the search would be equally to the advantage of science, and the improvement of the world; for without doubt there are some consequences of known causes which are not yet discovered, and I am as ready to believe there are yet in nature some *terra incognita*[14] both as to cause and consequence too.

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[11]The middle layer of the atmosphere, once believed to be the source of all meteorological phenomena and a cold boundary that contained the Earth's air.

[12]A philosophical term referring to the agent or force that directly produces an effect.

[13]Sir Francis Bacon.

[14]Terra incognita: Latin for "unknown land." Historically used by cartographers to label unexplored regions on a map; here used to describe the yet-to-be-discovered laws of nature.

In this search after causes, the philosopher, though he may at the same time be a very good Christian, cares not at all to meddle with his Maker: the reason is plain; we may at any time resolve all things into Infinite Power, and we do allow that the finger of the Infinite is the first mighty cause of nature herself: but the treasury of immediate cause is generally committed to nature; and if at any time we are driven to look beyond her, 'tis because we are out of the way: 'tis not because it is not in her, but because we cannot find it.

Two men met in the middle of a great wood; one was searching for a plant which grew in the wood, the other had lost himself in the wood, and wanted to get out: the latter rejoiced when through the trees he saw the open country; but the other man's business was not to get out, but to find what he looked for: yet this man no more undervalued the pleasantness of the champion country[15] than the other.

Thus in nature, the philosopher's business is not to look through nature, and come to the vast open field of Infinite Power; his business is in the wood; there grows the plant he looks for; and 'tis there he must find it. Philosophy's aground if it is forced to any farther inquiry. The Christian begins just where the philosopher ends; and when the inquirer turns his eyes up to Heaven, farewell philosopher; 'tis a sign he can make nothing of it here.

David was a good man, the Scripture gives him that testimony; but I am of the opinion, he was a better king than a scholar, more a saint than a philosopher: and it seems very proper to judge that David was upon the search of natural causes, and found himself puzzled as to the inquiry, when he finishes the inquiry with two pious ejaculations,[16] *When I view the heavens, the works of thy hands, the moon and the stars which thou hast made; then I say, what is man*![17] David may very rationally be supposed to be searching the causes, motions, and influences of heavenly bodies; and, finding his philosophy aground, and the discovery not to answer his search, he turns it all to a pious use, recognizes Infinite Power, and applies it to

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[15]Champion country: From the French "champagne"; refers to open, flat, or unenclosed land, providing a direct contrast to the "wood" of nature.

[16]Pious ejaculations: Short, sudden, and fervent prayers or exclamations.

[17]Psalm 8:3-4

the ecstasies and raptures of his soul, which were always employed in the charm of exalted praise.

Thus in another place we find him dissecting the womb of his mother, and deep in the study of anatomy; but having, as it may be well supposed, no help from Johan Remelini, or of the learned Riolanus, and other anatomists, famous for the most exquisite discovery of human body, and all the vessels of life, with their proper dimensions and use, all David could say to the matter was, *good man*, to look up to heaven, and admire what he could not understand, Psalm — *I was fearfully and wonderfully made*, etc.[18]

This is very good, and well becomes a pulpit; but what's all this to a philosopher? 'Tis not enough for him to know that God has made the heavens, the moon, and the stars, but must inform himself where he has placed them, and why there; and what their business, what their influences, their functions, and the end of their being. 'Tis not enough for an anatomist to know that he is fearfully and wonderfully made in the lowermost part of the earth, but he must see those lowermost parts; search into the method nature proceeds upon in the performing the office appointed, must search the steps she takes, the tools she works by; and in short, know all that the God of nature has permitted to be capable of demonstration.

And it seems a just authority for our search, that some things are so placed in nature by a chain of causes and effects, that upon a diligent search we may find out what we look for: to search after what God has in his sovereignty thought fit to conceal may be criminal, and doubtless is so; and the fruitlessness of the inquiry is generally part of the punishment to a vain curiosity: but to search after what our Maker has not hid, only covered with a thin veil of natural obscurity, and which upon our search is plain to be read, seems to be justified by the very nature of the thing, and the possibility of the demonstration is an argument to prove the lawfulness of the inquiry.

The design of this digression, is, in short, that as where nature is plain to be searched into, and demonstration easy, the philosopher is allowed to seek for it; so where God has, as it were, laid his hand upon any place, and nature presents us with an universal blank, we are therein led as naturally to recognize the Infinite Wisdom and Power of the God of nature, as David was in the texts before quoted.

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[18]Psalm 139:14.

And this is the case here; the winds, are some of those inscrutables of nature, in which human search has not yet been able to arrive at any demonstration.

"The winds," says the learned Mr. Bohun, "are generated in the intermediate space between the earth and the clouds, either by rarefaction or repletion, and sometimes haply by pressure of clouds, elastical virtue of the air, *etc.*, from the earth or seas, as by submarine or subterraneal eruption or descension or refilition from the middle region."

All this, though no man is more capable of the inquiry than this gentleman, yet to the demonstration of the thing, amounts to no more than what we had before, and still leaves it as abstruse and cloudy to our understanding as ever.

Not but that I think myself bound in duty to science in general, to pay a just debt to the excellency of philosophical study, in which I am a mere junior, and hardly any more than an admirer; and therefore I cannot but allow that the demonstrations made of rarefaction and dilatation are extraordinary; and that by fire and water wind may be raised in a close room, as the Lord Verulam made experiment in the case of his feathers.

But that, therefore, all the causes of wind are from the influences of the sun upon vaporous matter first exhaled, which being dilated are obliged to possess themselves of more space than before, and consequently make the particles fly before them; this does not seem to be a sufficient demonstration of wind: for this, to my weak apprehension, would rather make a blow like gunpowder than a rushing forward; at best this is indeed a probable conjecture, but admits not of demonstration equal to other phenomena in nature.

And this is all I am upon, *viz.*, that this case has not equal proofs of the natural causes of it that we meet with in other cases: the Scripture seems to confirm this, when it says, in one place, *He holds the wind in his hand*; as if he should mean, other things are left to the common discoveries of natural inquiry, but this is a thing he holds in his own hand, and has concealed it from the search of the most diligent and piercing understanding: this is farther confirmed by the words of our Saviour, *The wind blows where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but knowest not whence it cometh*; 'tis plainly expressed to signify that the causes of the wind are not equally discovered by natural inquiry as the rest of nature is.